

Important skills and core competencies that employers look for while hiring

Skills

1. Collect transmission data, study and analyse performance of reports on routine basis.
2. Generate transmission-quality reports on routine basis.
3. Study and analyse performance of the network, routers, switches and systems on routine basis.
4. Generate performance reports for network, routers, switches and systems.
5. Escalate network issues with suitable inputs that will help in prompt resolution of faults.
6. Work on analysing service degradation and customer complaints.
7. Proactively monitor and test network quality and performance on routine basis as per directives. Document the reports and findings and escalate the issues for resolution.
8. Coordinate the activities with various departments and colleagues.
9. Study the collected data, transform the data into report format, and document the statistics and reports.
10. Study, evaluate and analyse key performance indicators, and assist the supervisor with appropriate recommendations.
11. Test the effects of software changes/upgrade, hardware changes/upgrade, addition of new network elements or changes made in the network.
12. Collect statistics/data from the field and performance tool, study and analyse statistics, produce performance reports on regular basis and monitor key performance indicators.
13. Immediately escalate ambiguities/critical issues for corrective actions.
14. Develop cost analyses, design considerations and implementation time-lines.
15. Provide input for the development of capital and operational budgets, ensuring adequate provision has been made for the funding of all planned activities.

Core competencies

1. Strong analytical skills
2. Strong project management skills
3. Strong management skills
4. Strong technical skills
5. Strong interpersonal communication skills

—As told by Prof. Sanjay Sharma of Shobit University

sector also welcomes degree holders, diploma holders or even candidates with part-time certification courses.

To explain further, let's segregate the available engineering jobs under some broad categories. For instance, broadband network architects are people who provide IP network architecture solutions to clients for the next-generation network—a network based on IP, ATM and SONET. Wireless engineers develop potential wireless data applications, technology intelligence to identify and track wireless data products, and wireless data strategies. They also interact with vendors.

Another important category is network and application test engineers, who integrate, verify and deploy a full-service, high-speed data network providing nationally distributed video, voice, local programming and data

services. Also, network management and architecture/system engineers provide network management solutions to clients for currently planned deployments and next-generation network technologies. A position may include focus on all aspects of operations support. A combination of business, telecommunication and computer knowledge is optimal.

Grover informs, "The fresh recruits can look for various disciplines including switch engineer, RF engineer, NOC engineer, OSS/BTS/BSS engineers and others. Middle management professionals can explore career opportunities as network or project managers."

"With the coming of more and more projects, the telecom industry is going for high-scale recruitments. There is a huge demand for software engineers, mobile analysts and hard-

ware engineers for mobile handsets. Besides, there are ample opportunities for marketing people, whose services are required to capture more and more customer base. Given the exciting times ahead, the sector is a huge employment generator, likely to generate over 300,000 new jobs over the coming five years," Sharma opines.

What's on offer?

There is a huge demand for qualified and skilled professionals with technical knowledge and hands-on experience. Telecom players are luring the talent with handsome rewards in order to fulfil their rapid growth plans.

According to Sharma, "Suitably skilled candidates can expect a significant premium salary even at the starting level, owing to the challenges the industry is facing in terms of finding and recruiting proper talent. Industry experts believe that the talent crunch in this sector will push salaries even further from the current 15 per cent hike."

On an average, the sector offers freshers a starting salary of Rs 300,000 to Rs 500,000 per annum. Customer-facing jobs fetch something between Rs 200,000 and Rs 300,000 per annum. Experienced professionals can expect Rs 600,000 to 1,200,000 per annum.

Sapra opines, "There will be a lot of movement within the industry, with new companies willing to establish credibility in the market in the shortest possible time. Companies are even spending extra bucks to tap quality and experienced professionals. So for a professional of, say, five years experience, there is virtually no limit to the potential earnings. A package in the range of Rs 1,000,000 to 1,200,000 is along the expected lines. The industry is offering freshers competitive pay packages despite having to spend time and resources in training the manpower before they turn productive."

The year-to-year salary hike is quite satisfactory in comparison with other sectors. As an engineer, you could choose to continue in the technology field, be a part of the techno-